STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			AU-2500
SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 06/11/07	DATE REVISED **03/04/22**	DATE REVIEWED 2/02/25
	APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE AUXILIARY UNITS: SPECIAL WEAPONS AND TACTICS	RESOURCES		
SUBJECT CRITERIA FOR SWAT TEAM ACTIVATION	CROSS REFERENCE P-5000 HIGH RISK INCIDENTS P-5010 HIGH RISK INCIDENT COMMAND		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for the activation of the Sarpy County SWAT Team.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County SWAT Team shall be available twenty-four (24) hours a day for emergency situations that may require the team's response. Requests for immediate activation of the SWAT Team for high risks incidents shall be made through the High Risk Incident Commander (see P-5000 High Risk Incidents and P-5010 High Risk Incident Command). Other requests for the activation of the SWAT Team shall be made through the SWAT Team Command. If SWAT Team Command is unavailable, requests shall be made through a SWAT Team Leader.

III. Procedure:

A. Activation Criteria: The following are examples of emergency situations where the SWAT Team could be utilized. This list is not all-inclusive:

1. **Hostage Situations**: The holding of any person(s) against their will by an armed or potentially armed suspect.

2. **Barricade Situations**: A stand-off created by an armed or potentially armed suspect in any location, whether fortified or not, who is refusing to comply with police demands for surrender.

3. **High-Risk Warrant Service**: The service of search or arrest warrants where the warrant service assessment recommends or requires the use of the SWAT Team, or as otherwise requested.

4. **High-Risk Apprehension**: The arrest or apprehension of armed or potentially armed suspects where the likelihood of armed resistance is high (For example a Narcotics Buy/Bust).

5. **Active Shooter Situations**: The firing upon or killing of innocent citizens by an armed suspect, whether stationary or mobile.

6. **Rapid Deployment Situations**: Any life-threatening situation where SWAT Team Operators are called to assist in stabilizing the scene or to stop a deadly threat. Team members responding to a critical incident will work to stabilize the situation as soon as possible.

7. **VIP/ Dignitary Protection**: The security of special persons, such as VIP's, witnesses, or suspects, based on a threat or potential threat to the well-being of those persons.

8. **Crowd, Riot Control Situations**: The Team will assist in a Mobile Field Force operation to control or move unruly persons causing public disturbance or riot conditions. Team members will typically perform the duties of arrest teams, chemical agent deployment, less-lethal operators or lethal cover in these situations but may be utilized in other roles as needed.

9. **Special Event Coverage**: Any assignment approved by the SWAT Commander based upon the personnel, training, experience, or equipment of the Team.

10. **Crime Suppression Situations**: Utilization of the Team as a resource to patrol or investigations in situations when special tactics or equipment maybe necessary.

11. **Jail Riot Suppression/Cell Extraction and Reassignment**: When requested by Sarpy County Corrections, the team will use its skills to suppress an organized jail disturbance.

12. **Terrorist Response**: The Team will respond to any suspected act of terrorism.

13. Any situation in which an Agency commander determines that there is a need for a timely response of personnel or in which special equipment or weapons are necessary.

IV.

A. **SWAT Team Activation-High Risk Incident:** Any supervisor may request the SWAT Team during a high risk incident by contacting the High-Risk Incident Commander. The High-Risk Incident Commander (or the Adjunct High-Risk Incident Commander) shall make an immediate determination regarding the need for SWAT and shall have Communications notify the appropriate personnel (see P-5000 High Risk Incidents).

B. SWAT Team Activation-Emergency Situations: Any supervisor may request the SWAT Team during emergency situations that do not meet the criteria of a high-risk incident (e.g. search effort, cell extraction, natural disaster, etc.) by contacting SWAT Team Command. The SWAT Team Command shall determine the need for SWAT and shall have Communications notify the appropriate personnel. If the SWAT Team Command is unavailable, the supervisor shall contact a SWAT Team Leader.

C. SWAT Team Activation-Narcotics Search Warrants: Due to the potential for armed and dangerous suspects, the SWAT Team may be utilized to serve narcotics search warrants to lessen the potential danger to members of the Sheriff's Office and citizens. The following procedures shall be followed when a narcotics search warrant is obtained.

1. After obtaining a search warrant, the Narcotics Supervisor shall complete all necessary background checks and complete the SWAT Risk Assessment form, to determine the need for the SWAT Team. The Narcotics Supervisor shall then notify and brief the SWAT Team Command regarding the application for the search warrant.

2. If the SWAT Team Command is unavailable, the Narcotics Supervisor shall notify a SWAT Team Leader.

3. If it has been determined that SWAT team will serve the warrant, the Narcotics Supervisor shall notify the SWAT Team Command when he or she receives the search warrant and shall set a time for the execution of the warrant.

4. The SWAT Team Command shall have Communications notify the SWAT Team members, including two (2) tactical medics if available, and provide a time and location for the briefing.

5. The Narcotics Supervisor or a narcotics investigator shall be present during the briefing to provide additional information regarding the search warrant.

6. The Narcotics Unit shall be responsible for the scene and completion of the search after SWAT Team has served the warrant and secured the suspects.

D. SWAT Team Activation-Arrest: The following procedures shall be followed when a felony arrest warrant is issued by the court.

1. The Warrants/Extradition Unit Supervisor or his or her designee shall complete a records check and a background investigation of the wanted suspect.

2. After completion of all necessary background checks, the Warrants/Extradition Unit Supervisor shall determine the need for the SWAT Team and complete the SWAT Risk Assessment form. The following criteria shall be used to make the determination.

a) The arrest warrant is for a violent felony (e.g. homicide, first degree assault, etc.).

b) The suspect has a previous history of violence, resisting arrest, and/or weapons possession.

c) There is a high probability the suspect will resist arrest.

d) There is a high probability the suspect can be found at a specific location.

3. If the Warrants Unit Supervisor determines the need for the SWAT Team, he or she shall notify and brief the SWAT Team Command. The Warrants Unit Supervisor shall also notify the Investigations Division Commander.

4. If the SWAT Team Command is unavailable, the Warrants/Extradition Unit Supervisor shall notify a SWAT Team Leader.

5. If the SWAT Team Commander concurs regarding the need for the SWAT Team to serve the arrest warrant, the SWAT Team Command shall have Communications notify the SWAT Team members, including two (2) tactical medics, and provide a time and location for the briefing.

6. The Warrants Unit Supervisor or a warrants investigator shall be present during the briefing to provide additional information regarding the warrant.

7. Generally, the Warrants Unit shall be responsible for the transportation of the suspect after he or she has been taken into custody by the SWAT Team.

E. **SWAT Team Activation-Search Warrant:** In the event the Investigations Division makes application for a search warrant which may be of a high risk nature, the Investigations Commander shall adhere to the procedures outlined in section D of this policy (SWAT Team Activation-Narcotics Search Warrants).

F. **SWAT Team Activation-Outside Agency:** Requests for the use of the SWAT Team in response to an emergency situation which come from sources outside the SWAT Team member agencies shall be directed to the SWAT Team Command.

1. The SWAT Team Command shall determine if the SWAT Team shall respond to the request.

2. If the SWAT Team Command is unavailable, a SWAT Team Leader shall make the determination.

3. The requesting agency shall be advised of the following:

a) The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall assume command authority for the coordination of activities associated with the efforts to resolve the high-risk incident. This shall include control over the inner-perimeter and all tactical planning.

b) The Sheriff's Office may rely on the resources available from other outside agencies, including the requesting agency, to assist in the coordination of activities pertaining to establishment of a field command post, evacuation of the perimeter and traffic control.

c) The Sheriff's Office shall assume responsibility for making all decisions regarding the actions of the SWAT Team.

4. The Sheriff or Chief Deputy shall authorize the use of the SWAT Team to assist any outside agency prior to deployment.